squaring off against the rest of us. Pierre bitterly lit into Margaret, the chairman of the meeting, and told her she was being heavy-handed and undemocratic in dealing with their objections. I was horrified by his rudeness and the insulting way that he spoke to her; but she ignored him, kept her cool, and never skipped a beat. When the session was over, I caught up with her in the hall and said, “Margaret, he had no business talking to you like that, he was way out of line.” But she just said very quietly: “Oh, women know when men are being childish.”

That night over dinner at Buckingham Palace, Pierre mentioned that he had read someplace that I could recite by heart “The Shooting of Dan McGrew” by the Canadian poet and storyteller Robert W. Service. I’m not sure he really believed I could do it; maybe he just wanted to put me on the spot and see how I’d handle it. Sitting between Pierre and me was the Queen Mother, and as it turned out she was a great fan of that story and one of its characters, “the lady known as Lou.” So when she heard what Pierre said, she turned to me and said, “Oh, do you know ‘The Shooting of Dan McGrew’?”

I said, well, yes, then she started urging me to say it. She wouldn’t let up, and the whole table fell silent waiting to see what I would do. Across the table were Prince Philip and the queen. Everybody was waiting for me. I was on the spot, and so I plunged into reciting that poem I’d memorized when I was a lad back in Dixon, and every time I said “the lady named Lou,” the Queen Mother chimed in with me. When we were through, everybody at the table applauded.

All in all, it was a memorable evening.

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Although there were a few problems at the economic summits, they were, by and large, productive forums for